JUSTIN THOMAS

Construction Project Manager · Utility-Scale Solar & BESS · Renewables EPC

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~3.9 GW	~1 GWh	11+ yrs	145 kV
UTILITY-SCALE SOLAR	BATTERY STORAGE (BESS)	CONSTRUCTION INDUSTRY	GRID INTERCONNECTION

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Construction Project Manager with 11+ years in the renewable construction industry, delivering utility-scale solar and battery energy storage (BESS) projects, about 3.9 GW of solar and 1 GWh of storage, from construction start-up through testing, commissioning, closeout and handover. Has managed multiple concurrent projects from the EPC contractor, owner's engineer and developer sides of the contract, so understands how scope, schedule, quality, risk and contract changes look to every stakeholder. Builds a culture of safety, quality and accountability on site, directs contractors, vendors, equipment and materials against the project execution plan, and mentors project teams. Brings grid-resilience experience across BESS, MV/HV balance of plant and 145 kV substation interconnection. Certified Lean Six Sigma Green Belt.

CORE COMPETENCIES

- Utility-Scale Solar & BESS Construction
- Multi-Project Management
- Project Execution Planning
- Schedule Control & Progress Reporting
- Scope, Risk & Change Management
- Contract Documents & Deviation Control
- Safety Culture, HSE & Permit-to-Work
- Quality Management (ISO 9001:2015)
- QAP / ITP, NCR, RCA & CAPA
- Subcontractor & Vendor Management
- Procurement, FAT & Material Inspection
- Blueprint & Drawing Review
- Stakeholder Communication & Reporting
- Testing, Commissioning & Closeout
- Team Leadership & Mentoring

Tools: Microsoft Office (Excel, Word, PowerPoint) · MS Project · AutoCAD · DPR / MIS reporting · RFI, NCR & document-control registers · IEC / IEEE standards

PROJECT PORTFOLIO

PROJECT	CAPACITY	TYPE	DELIVERY ROLE
JSW Renew Energy 38L standalone BESS, Kerala	125 MW / 500 MWh	LFP BESS	EPC contractor (Amara Raja Infra)
Khavda BESS + solar hybrid, Gujarat	500 MW	BESS + PV	Owner's engineer (TQ Cert / Tata Projects)
Siyambar / Bandha solar, Rajasthan	1,034 MW	Solar PV	Owner's engineer (TQ Cert / Tata Projects)
Bikaner solar, Rajasthan	450 MWp / 335 MWac	Solar PV	Owner / developer (Tata Power Renewables)
Dholera solar, Gujarat	300 MW	Solar PV	Owner / developer (Tata Power Renewables)
Pavagada Solar Park, Karnataka	2,050 MW	Solar PV	Implementing agency (SECI)
Lakshadweep island BESS	1.4 MWh	BESS	Implementing agency (SECI)
Cochin International Airport solar, Kerala	25.4 MW	Solar PV	EPC execution (KC Kopar Energy)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Manager, Electrical Projects · Amara Raja Infra Pvt. Ltd. (EPC Contractor) — Aug 2025 – Present

125 MW / 500 MWh standalone LFP BESS for JSW Renew Energy, Kasaragod, Kerala · Owner's engineer: Tata Consulting Engineers

- Leads electrical construction of one of India's largest battery storage projects under construction, covering containerised LFP battery systems, power conversion systems (PCS), MV/HV balance of plant and the 145 kV grid interconnection.
- Directs electrical contractors, equipment and materials against the project execution plan and schedule for the BESS and balance-of-plant scope.
- Manages procurement and the vendor interface with 8 OEMs and suppliers (Gotion, Hopewind, Shilchar, Trisquare, CG Power, KEC, Smart Grid, Fuji Electric), from drawing approval and pre-dispatch inspection to site acceptance and defect closure.

- Set up the site quality management system: an RFI register with 278 entries tracked to closure, NCR and observation control, root cause analysis and CAPA, and post-pour foundation inspection checklists. The site stays audit-ready for the owner's engineer and client.
- Reports progress, issues and risks to client and owner's engineer stakeholders, and enforces HSE and permit-to-work compliance across the jobsite.

Owner's Engineer, Quality & Inspection · TQ Cert Services (Tata Projects Ltd.) `Aug 2023 – Aug 2025`

500 MW BESS + solar hybrid, Khavda, Gujarat · 1,034 MW Siyambar / Bandha solar, Jaisalmer, Rajasthan

- Acted as the owner's technical and quality authority on two concurrent utility-scale programmes totalling over 1.5 GW, and governed EPC contractor and subcontractor performance on scope, quality and schedule.
- Reviewed and approved contractor quality assurance plans, inspection and test plans and field quality procedures. Enforced hold and witness points so that stage clearances rested on evidence.
- Ran factory acceptance tests and pre-dispatch inspections at OEM works for PV modules, inverters, transformers, switchgear and battery systems, so non-conforming material never reached site.
- Reviewed designs, drawings and technical specifications, decided contract deviation and concession requests on technical merit, and issued and closed non-conformance reports through quality audits.

Project Lead · Tata Power Renewable Energy Ltd. (Owner / Developer) `Aug 2022 – Aug 2023`

450 MWp / 335 MWac solar, Bikaner, Rajasthan · 300 MW solar, Dholera, Gujarat

- Led construction execution for about 750 MW of utility-scale solar across two states at the same time, holding EPC contractors to schedule, quality and safety commitments on behalf of the asset owner.
- Controlled progress through site reviews, milestone verification and punch-list closure, and brought projects to commissioning and commercial operation readiness.
- Integrated engineering, procurement, contracts, HSE and O&M teams to resolve interface issues and keep multi-package sites in sequence.

Project Engineer, Implementation · Solar Energy Corporation of India (SECI) `Oct 2020 – Aug 2022`

2,050 MW Pavagada Solar Park, Karnataka · 1.4 MWh island BESS, Lakshadweep

- Monitored developer and contractor delivery against scheme milestones on the 2,050 MW Pavagada Solar Park, one of the world's largest solar parks.
- Delivered a 1.4 MWh island battery storage installation under logistically constrained conditions, including battery system integration.
- Worked with contracts, tendering, regulatory requirements and stakeholders, which now informs contract-aware decisions in construction.

Electrical Engineer, Execution · KC Kopar Energy Solutions `Jun 2015 – Oct 2020`

25.4 MW solar at Cochin International Airport, the world's first fully solar-powered airport

- Built 25.4 MW of ground-mount, rooftop and canopy solar inside a live, security-controlled airport, and kept the site safe while airport operations continued.
- Managed installation, testing and commissioning of PV modules, inverters, LT/HT switchgear, transformers and evacuation infrastructure, then ran preventive maintenance and fault diagnosis on the operating plant.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

B.Tech, Electrical & Electronics Engineering
SCMS School of Engineering & Technology, Cochin
`2011 – 2015`

Certified Lean Six Sigma Green Belt (CLSSGB)
Process improvement and quality tools